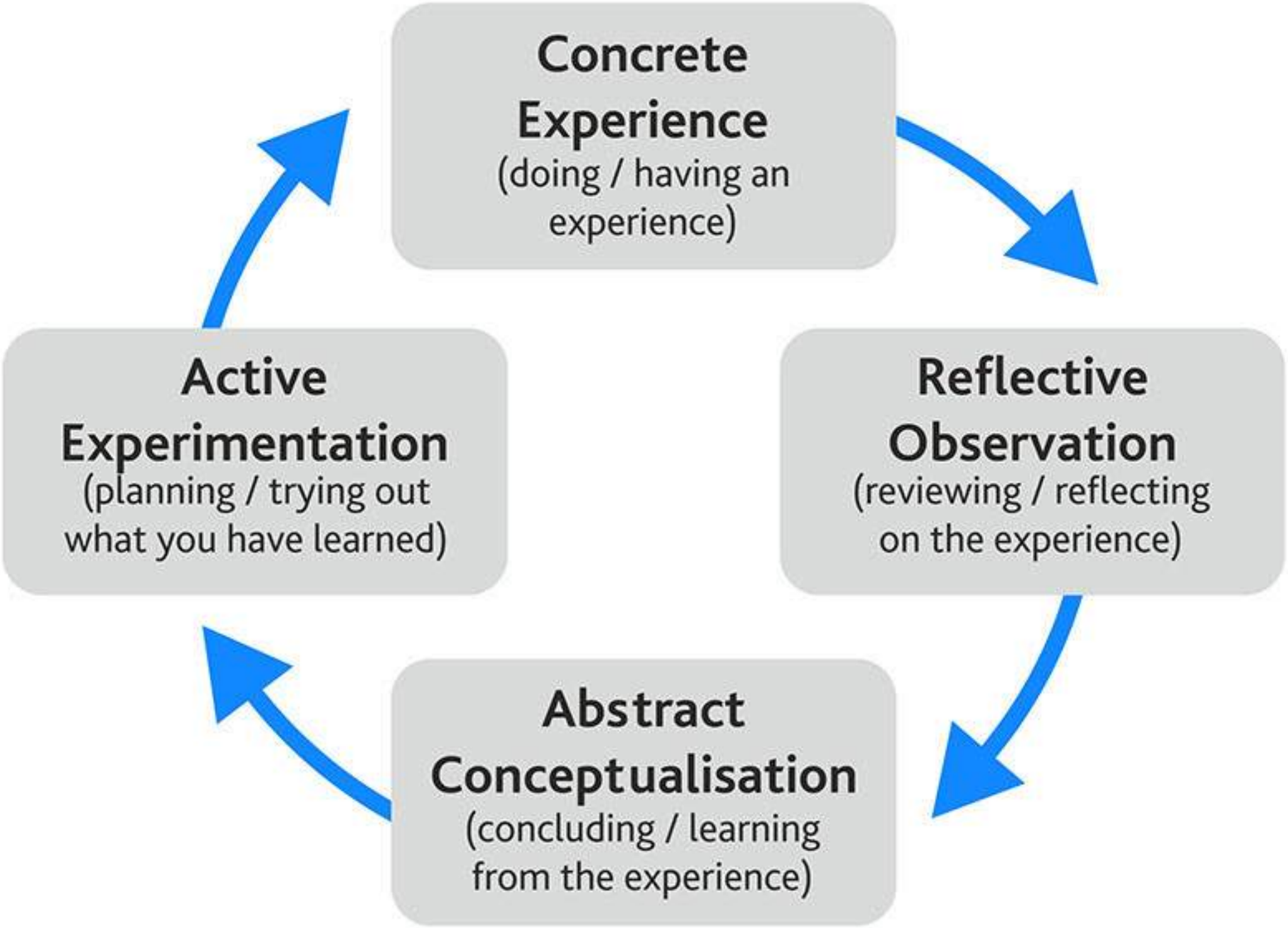
The Experiential Learning Cycle



Concrete Experience

Directly engage in an experience, often a new situation or task. This involves active participation and the use of senses and emotions, creating a personal connection to the learning process. The experience serves as a foundation for further exploration.

Reflective Observation

After the experience, take time to reflect on what occurred. Analyze your thoughts, emotions, and reactions during the experience. Identify patterns, surprises, and insights that emerged. This reflection helps to gain a deeper understanding of the experience and its impact.

Abstract Conceptualization

Connect your reflections to existing concepts, theories, or knowledge. Form hypotheses or explanations based on your observations. Seek to understand the underlying principles that contributed to the experience. This stage involves integrating new insights with your existing understanding.

Active Experimentation

Take the insights and theories derived from your reflection and apply them in a new practical situation. Test hypotheses, make decisions, and take actions based on your understanding. This process involves actively engaging with real-world scenarios, which leads to new concrete experiences and restarts the cycle.